FREE PROTOCOL · KOREAN WELLNESS × CIRCADIAN SCIENCE

Sleep Better *Tonight.*

5 evidence-based Korean wellness habits — each one shifts your circadian system.
Start with one. Let them compound.

5
PROTOCOLS

FOUNDATION PROTOCOLS

01

Morning Light — First 30 Minutes

Within 30 minutes of waking, step outside. You don't need to walk — just be outside for 2 minutes. Even on cloudy days, outdoor light is 10–50× brighter than indoor light. This single habit sets your cortisol peak earlier, which means melatonin rises earlier that night — and you fall asleep when you want to, not when your body finally gives up.

> *Natural light triggers the cortisol awakening response — your circadian clock's daily reset button. The earlier you trigger it, the earlier your whole rhythm shifts forward.*

02

The Sleep Anchor — Same Time, Every Day

Pick a wake time and hold it within 30 minutes — including weekends. Not the earliest time possible, but the earliest you can genuinely sustain. Everything else — when you feel sleepy, when melatonin rises, when cortisol peaks — adjusts around it within 3–5 days. Sleeping in on Saturday quietly resets the whole clock back.

> *Your circadian system is a training system, not a passive one. Consistency is the strongest zeitgeber (timing signal) you have — stronger than supplements, stronger than blackout blinds.*

DAILY RHYTHM ADJUSTMENTS

03

Caffeine Cutoff — 2pm Hard Stop

No caffeine after 2pm. Caffeine's half-life is 5–6 hours — a 3pm coffee is still half-strength at 8pm, blocking the adenosine that builds your sleep pressure all day. You feel exhausted but wired. Cut it at 2pm and notice the difference by night 3.

> *Adenosine is the hourglass — fills while you're awake. Caffeine blocks the sensor. The sand still falls, but your brain can't feel it until the drug clears.*

04

Dim Everything After 8pm

Every light source — phone, overheads, TV — tells your brain it's still afternoon. Melatonin cannot rise while your retinas detect brightness. Dim every screen, switch to warm side-lamps. Give yourself 90 minutes of dim before your anchor bedtime.

> *Melatonin is a blackout blind — it can only close when darkness signals safety. Any light leaks through. One hour of dimming buys 45+ minutes of earlier onset.*

05

The 3am Reset Protocol

If you wake: no phone, no light. Stay horizontal. Breathe through your nose — 4 counts in, hold 4, out for 8. Repeat three times. This activates your parasympathetic nervous system and drops cortisol back below the arousal threshold.

> *3am waking is cortisol rising normally but crossing the arousal threshold too early. The 4–4–8 breath pattern drops it within 2–3 cycles. Clinical, not mystical.*

생활

Saenghwal — the rhythm of daily life

Korean tradition built circadian science into everyday living — before it had a name. These protocols are not hacks. They are saenghwal. The daily rhythm your body already knows how to follow.

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